ITALY Sea arrivals dashboard

Overview

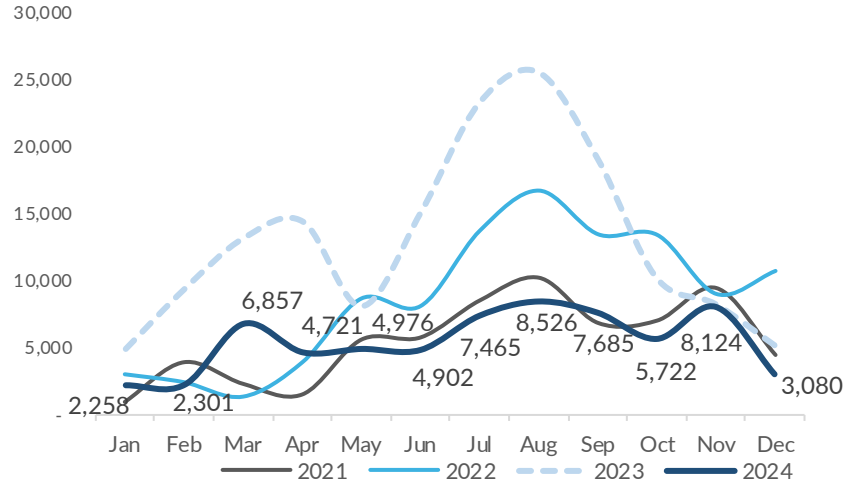
In 2024, 66,617 refugees and migrants arrived in Italy by sea, compared to 157,651 in the same period last year, marking a 58 per cent decrease. Most of the 3,080 people who arrived in December disembarked in Sicily (81%, 2,505), followed by Emilia-Romagna (163), Sardinia (137), Abruzzo (114), Calabria (82), Puglia (45) and Marche (34) regions.

66,617 Jan-Dec 2024 [1]

157,651 Jan-Dec 2023 [1]

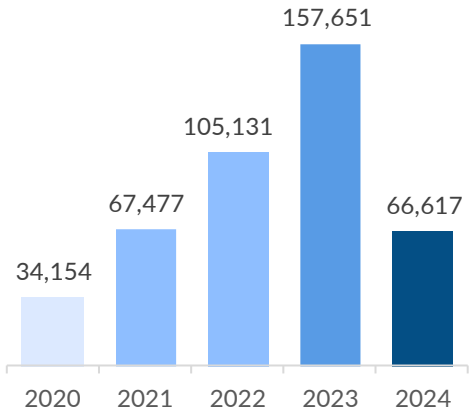
Monthly sea arrivals

January 2021 to December 2024



Yearly sea arrivals

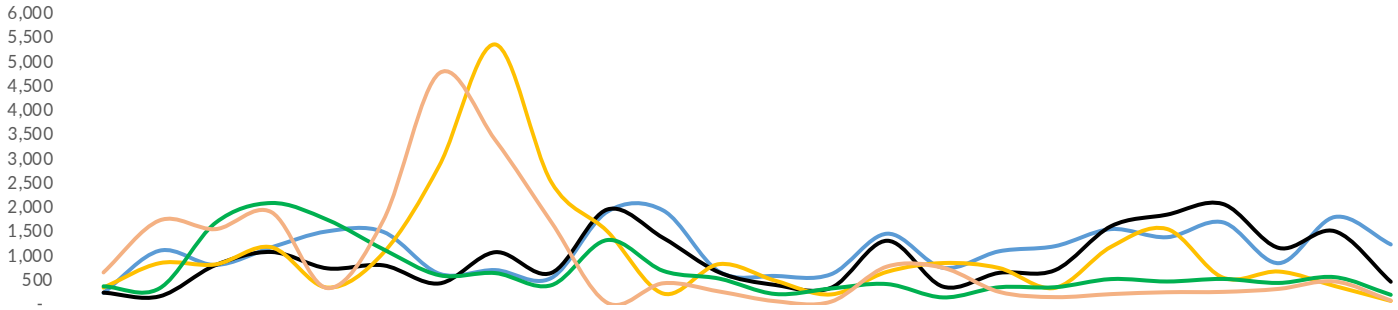
January to December, 2020-2024



Nationality of arrivals

In December, Bangladeshis accounted for 40 per cent of all arrivals by sea (compared to 22% in November), followed by Syrians (15%, compared to 19% in November) and Pakistanis (14%, compared to 9% in November). Among other nationalities of significant numbers arriving by sea were Egyptians (6%), Algerians (4%), Malians and Afghans (3% each), Tunisians and Guineans (2% each). In December, the main nationalities of those departing from Libya were Bangladeshis (50%, 30% in November), Syrians (19%, 25% in November) and Pakistanis (17%, 11% in November). Most of those departing from Tunisia were Tunisians (22%, 23% in November), Guineans (20%, 27% in November), and Malians (16%, 9% in November). Most of those departing from Türkiye were Afghans (70%, 52% in November), Iranians (26%, 19% in November), and Iraqis (2%, 14% in November). All those departing from Algeria were Algerians (100%, as in November).

Most common nationalities of people arriving by sea - January 2023 to December 2024



	Jan-23	Feb-23	Mar-23	Apr-23	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Bangladesh	232	1,110	813	1,180	1,514	1,502	631	707	542	1,921	1,948	674	585	621	1,464	755	1,098	1,205	1,560	1,391	1,701	851	1,813	1,240
Syrian Arab Rep.	253	176	818	1,089	752	814	442	1,085	658	1,963	1,378	670	411	353	1,320	376	660	715	1,619	1,857	2,076	1,172	1,515	476
Tunisia	347	850	825	1,178	348	1,062	2,858	5,352	2,520	1,508	225	831	491	207	673	853	751	342	1,187	1,554	553	678	379	73
Egypt	359	316	1,691	2,109	1,757	1,137	592	637	382	1,331	683	521	198	313	406	126	339	340	511	460	514	430	551	180
Guinea	652	1,724	1,545	1,896	329	1,726	4,762	3,382	1,692	26	429	259	59	50	774	748	252	143	205	244	251	313	466	72

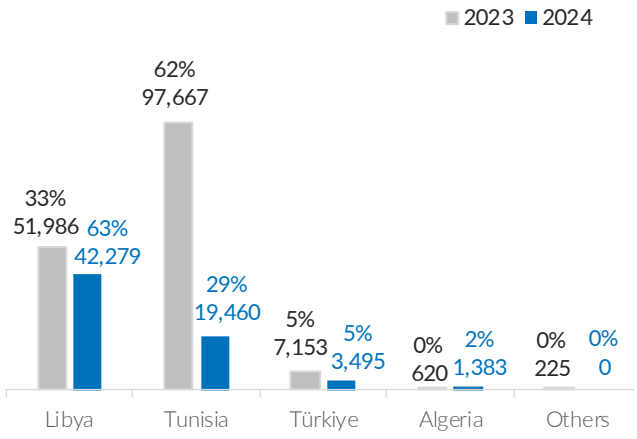
more information: data.unhcr.org/en/situations/mediterranean

[1] All data are based on official Ministry of Interior figures shared with UNHCR. All figures are provisional and subject to change.

Country of embarkation

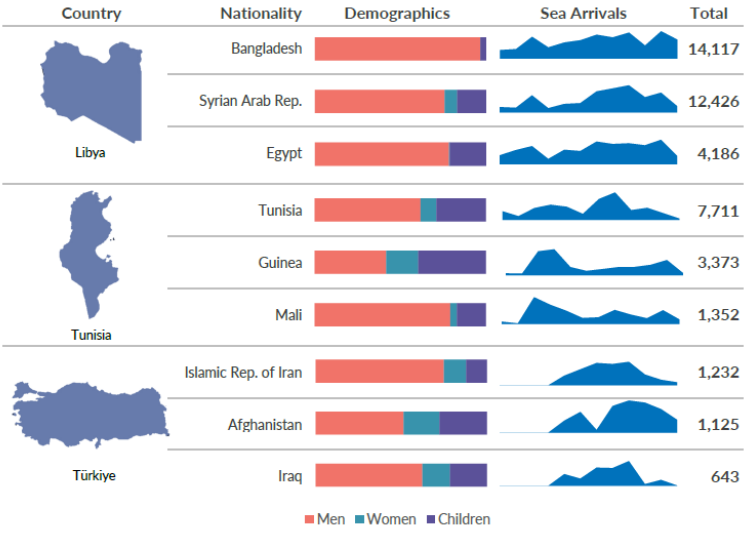
In 2024, 63 per cent of the people reaching Italy via sea departed from Libya (42,279 people in 899 landings), followed by 29 per cent from Tunisia (19,460 people in 656 landings), 5 per cent from Türkiye (3,495 people in 49 landings), and 2 per cent from Algeria (1,383 people in 143 landings). In December, as in November, Libya was the main country of departure (81% of all persons arriving in Italy) by sea, followed by Tunisia (11%, down from 20% in November), Türkiye (4%, as in November) and Algeria (4%, up from 2% in November).

January to December 2023 - 2024



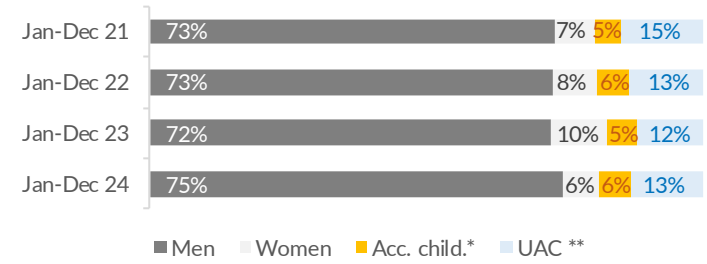
Figures may not add up to 100 per cent due to rounding.

Top 3 nationalities by country of embarkation, January to December 2024



Demographics of arrivals

January to December 2021 - 2024



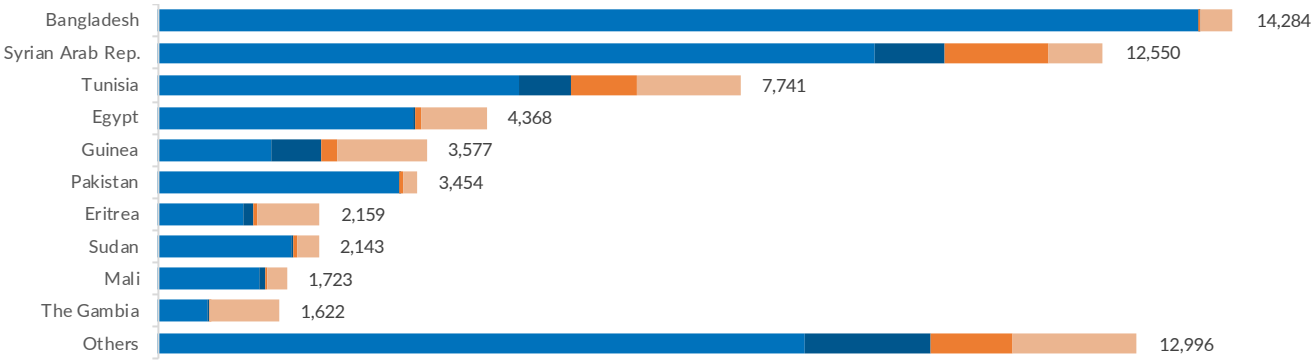
Figures may not add up to 100 per cent due to rounding.

In 2024, most people arriving by sea were adult males (75%), followed by unaccompanied children (UAC, 13%), adult females (6%) and accompanied children (6%).

In December, 155 adult females reached Italian shores, mainly originating from the Syrian Arab Republic (69), Afghanistan (22), Tunisia (14) and the Islamic Republic of Iran (7).

In the same month, 272 UAC arrived in Italy by sea. The main nationalities were Bangladeshi (55), Guinean (37), Egyptian (36) and Pakistani (25).

Nationality and demographics of arrivals – January to December 2024

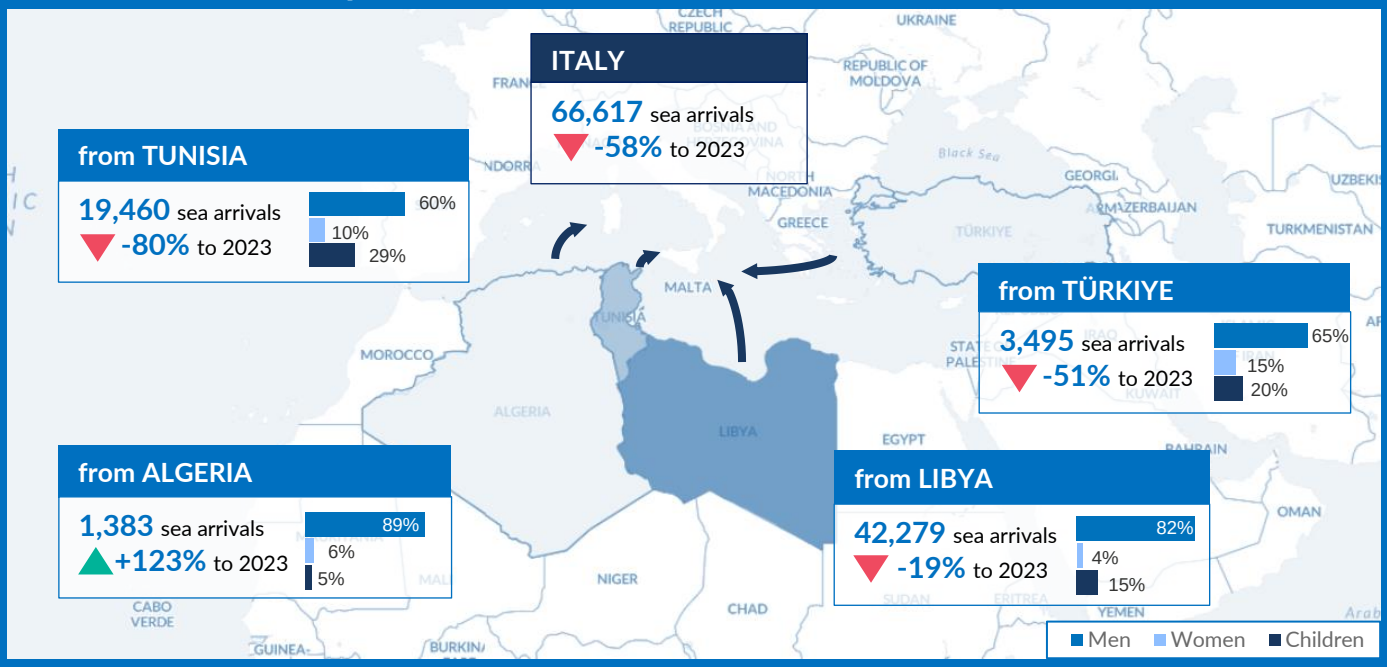


	Others	The Gambia	Mali	Sudan	Eritrea	Pakistan	Guinea	Egypt	Tunisia	Syrian Arab Rep.	Bangladesh	Total
Men	8,603	672	1,355	1,763	1,125	3,212	1,498	3,388	4,796	9,523	13,812	49,747
Women	1,670	13	69	29	153	6	673	21	708	929	5	4,276
Acc. child.*	1,079	11	43	58	51	32	210	104	856	1,377	21	3,842
UAC **	1,644	926	256	293	830	204	1,196	855	1,381	721	446	8,752
Total	12,996	1,622	1,723	2,143	2,159	3,454	3,577	4,368	7,741	12,550	14,284	66,617

* Accompanied children ** Unaccompanied children

2024 FOCUS

Sea arrivals to Italy in 2024



The boundaries and names shown, and the designations used on this map do not imply official endorsement or acceptance by the United Nations. Please note that 'children' in this map refer to both accompanied and unaccompanied children. Due to rounding, percentages may not add up to 100 per cent exactly.

Overview

In 2024, 66,617 refugees and migrants arrived in Italy by sea across 1,747 separate landings, marking a significant reversal in trends following four consecutive years of steady increases, and representing a 58 per cent reduction compared to 2023. Notably, 2024 was the fourth lowest year of sea arrivals in the past decade. Despite the decrease in the number of sea arrivals, 1,718 refugees and migrants lost their lives or went missing at sea while attempting to cross the Central Mediterranean towards Italy, averaging 1 every 39 people arriving by sea compared to 1 in 83 in 2023—highlighting a rise in the incidence of death and missing persons along this route.[2]

Routes travelled by refugees and migrants

The significant decrease in arrivals by sea to Italy in 2024 is a direct consequence of the overall decrease in departures on all routes and in particular from Tunisia. Notably, the number of individuals departing from Tunisia fell by 80 per cent, from nearly 100,000 in 2023 to under 20,000 in 2024, a downward trend that was already evident in the last quarter of 2023. Similarly, arrivals from Türkiye decreased by 51 per cent, while those from Libya declined by 19 per cent, with most departures continuing to originate from Tripolitania. In contrast, the only route to experience an increase was the one from Algeria, where departures rose by 123 per cent. However, the absolute number of arrivals from Algeria remained low, with 1,383 individuals reaching Italy—thus not significantly affecting overall figures. No landings from Cyprus, Lebanon, Greece (since 2022), or Egypt (since 2021) were recorded in 2024.

In 2024, the island of Lampedusa remained the main port of disembarkation in Italy, with over 45,500 sea arrivals, accounting for 68 per cent of all arrivals by sea—mirroring the proportion recorded in 2023. Other main disembarkation points included the island of Sicily (9%), Calabria (6%), and Sardinia (2%), followed by smaller shares from other Italian regions. The proportion of sea arrivals disembarking in Lampedusa remained consistent year-on-year, notwithstanding a reduction in departures from Tunisia, whose geographic proximity has historically resulted in a high number of arrivals. This relative stability in arrivals to Lampedusa can be partly attributed to an increased use of small vessels departing

[2] Data source: IOM Missing Migrants Project.

from Libya—the primary country of departure in 2024. Although smaller boats carried fewer individuals on average (47 persons per vessel in 2024, compared to 80 in 2023), their reduced range made Lampedusa a more frequent point of disembarkation due to its closer proximity.

Nationalities of refugees and migrants

In 2024, individuals of 57 different nationalities were registered at disembarkation sites in Italy. The top six countries of origin were Bangladesh (21%), the Syrian Arab Republic (19%), Tunisia (12%), Egypt (7%), and Guinea and Pakistan (5% each). The reduction in departures from Tunisia significantly impacted the nationality composition of arrivals, leading to a marked decrease in West African nationals. Tunisians became the main nationality departing from Tunisia, representing 40 per cent of all departures from the country—up from 18 per cent in the previous year. However, in absolute terms, fewer Tunisian nationals crossed the Mediterranean in 2024 compared to 2023 (7,741 vs. 17,904 individuals). No significant re-routing of West African nationals from Tunisia to Libya was observed. Other nationalities departing from Tunisia included Guineans, Gambians, Malians, and Sudanese. Nationals from Asia, as well as North and East Africa, primarily crossed the Central Mediterranean from Libya. On this route, the top five countries of origin were Bangladesh, the Syrian Arab Republic, Egypt, Pakistan, and Eritrea. Among them, Asian nationals and Syrians reportedly traveled by air to Benghazi before moving onward to Tripolitania for embarkation. Along the Türkiye route, the main nationalities recorded were Iranian, Afghan, Iraqi, and Pakistani.

In 2024, there was a notable increase in arrivals from Bangladesh and the Syrian Arab Republic. Despite the overall reduction in sea arrivals, over 14,200 Bangladeshis (+12% compared to 2023) and 12,550 Syrians (+24% compared to 2023) reached Italy. One of the main reasons for the increase is linked to the existence of smuggling businesses that rely on flight routes to Benina Benghazi Airport in Tripolitania. Additionally, there were increases in arrivals from other nationalities, though in smaller numbers: Ethiopians saw a 21 per cent rise (from 1,064 to 1,289 people), and Somalis increased by 11 per cent (from 584 to 648 people).

Profiles of refugees and migrants

In line with previous years, in 2024, most individuals arriving in Italy by sea continued to be adult males, accounting for 75 per cent of total sea arrivals. In the same year, the proportion of women among sea arrivals declined significantly, from 10 per cent in 2023 to 6 per cent in 2024, representing a 73 per cent decrease in absolute numbers 15,967 in 2023 vs. 4,276 in 2024). The reduction was largely attributed to fewer arrivals along routes traditionally used by women, particularly those from Tunisia, mostly used by Sub-Saharans, and Türkiye, mostly used by Afghans. Likewise, Libya was less frequently used as a transit country by female refugees and migrants, as well as families.

In 2024, the Syrian Arab Republic was the main country of origin for women arriving in Italy via sea, representing 22 per cent of all female sea arrivals (approximately 1 in 5), with the majority of Syrian women having departed from Libya. Other countries of origin of women included Tunisia (17%), Guinea (16%), Côte d'Ivoire (6%), and Afghanistan (5%).

In 2024, unaccompanied children (UAC) represented 13 per cent of all sea arrivals to Italy, totalling 8,752 individuals. This proportion is in line with trends observed in previous years, when UAC arrivals fluctuated between 12 and 15 per cent. The top nationalities of UAC in 2024 were Tunisia (16%), Guinea (14%), The Gambia (11%), Egypt (10%), and Eritrea (9%).